wizz

A PARENT'S PLAIN-ENGLISH GUIDE

CYBER SAFETY GUY

Wizz is a social discovery app that helps people meet and chat with new people. Users swipe through profiles, send chat requests and build connections. It's designed for "friend making", but many users treat it like a dating app.

It can be fun and positive — but it also comes with real risks. Here's what parents need to know.

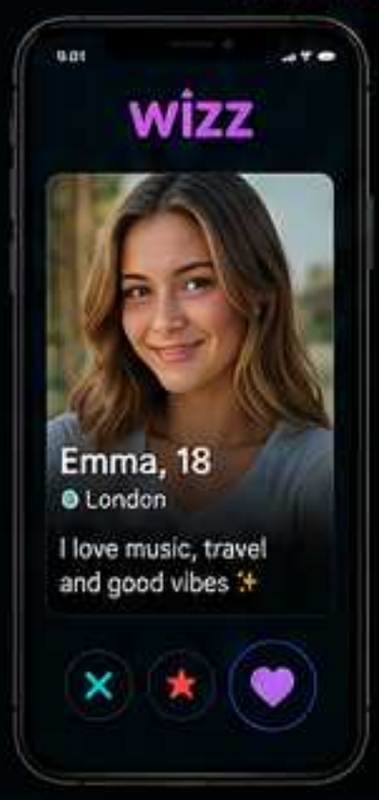
15M+ DOWNLOADS
Wizz has more than 15 million downloads worldwide.
Source: App Store & Google Play

SWIPE & CHAT DESIGN
Swipe through profiles and send chat requests to start a conversation.

AGE-VERIFIED PROFILES
Uses facial age estimation to help keep users in the right age groups.
Source: wizzapp.com

STRANGER MESSAGING RISKS
Messaging with strangers always carries risk.

WHAT IS WIZZ?



Swipe Profiles
Browse people nearby or in your chosen area.

Chat Requests
Send a request and chat when accepted.

Public Profiles
Users share photos, age, bio and interests.

Find Friends
Designed to help you meet and make friends.

Boosts & Perks
Premium features and boosts increase visibility.

Wizz is for 16+ in the UK and many other countries. Always check the age rating in your app store.

WHY YOUNG PEOPLE USE IT

Meet New People
Easy way to connect with people beyond their school or area.

Make Online Friends
Find people with similar interests and build friendships.

Quick & Easy
Swipe, match and chat in just a few taps.

Feel Good Factor
Likes, matches and replies can boost confidence and validation.

Feels Like Social Media
Familiar swipe interface similar to other apps they use.

The more time spent on the app, the more likely teens are to crave attention and validation.

RISKS PARENTS SHOULD KNOW

Contact With Strangers
Anyone can create a profile and message your child. Not everyone is who they say they are.

Catfishing & Fake Profiles
People may use fake photos, ages and bios to trick or manipulate others.

Sexual Messages & Content
Some users may send sexual messages or ask for photos.

Grooming & Manipulation
Predators can build trust over time to control or exploit young people.

Sextortion & Blackmail
Explicit photos or videos can be used to threaten or blackmail.

Pressure To Move Off-App
Users may push to move the chat to Snapchat, Instagram or other apps where it's harder for you to see or control.

Appearance Pressure
Constant swiping and comparison can affect self-esteem and body image.

Once something is shared online, you lose control of it.

WIZZ SAFETY FEATURES

Age Verification
Facial age estimation helps keep users in age-appropriate groups.

Profile Verification
Users can verify their profile to build trust.

Report & Block
Report inappropriate users and block anyone you don't want to talk to.

Content Moderation
Wizz monitors content and takes action against rule breakers.



Safety tools help, but they are not foolproof. Parental awareness and open conversations matter most.

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1. **Most interactions are with strangers.** Even if someone seems friendly, you don't really know who they are.
2. **Profiles can be misleading.** Photos, age, location and interests can be fake or exaggerated.
3. **Private conversations increase risk.** The more personal the conversation, the greater the potential for harm.

Stay involved, build trust and keep the conversation open and ongoing.

CONVERSATION STARTERS

- What do you like most about Wizz?
- Who do you usually talk to on the app?
- Do you know everyone you chat with?
- Has anyone said or done something that made you uncomfortable?
- What would you do if someone asked you for photos or to move to another app?
- Can we look at your privacy settings together?



RED FLAGS TO WATCH FOR

- Spending a lot of time on Wizz or being secretive
- New "online friends" they won't tell you about
- Moving conversations off the app quickly
- Receiving compliments, gifts or money offers
- Asking for or sending nudes or inappropriate photos
- Talking about meeting in person
- Mood changes after using the app

If something feels wrong, trust your instincts and talk to your child.

TIPS TO KEEP YOUR CHILD SAFE

- Talk regularly about online friendships and relationships.
- Set clear boundaries around apps and screen time.
- Encourage them to keep chats on the app and not share personal info.
- Never share photos of themselves with someone they just met.
- Use strong privacy settings and block/report when needed.
- Remind them that they can always come to you.
- Focus on trust, not just rules.

QUICK DO'S

- Encourage open conversations
- Know their online world
- Use parental controls
- Review privacy settings
- Be a trusted place to talk

DON'TS

- Don't spy or snoop.
- Don't overreact—listen first
- Don't shame or blame
- Don't ignore problems
- Don't dismiss their feelings.

WHERE TO GET HELP

Childline
0800 1111
childline.org.uk

The Mix
0808 808 4994
themix.org.uk

Internet Matters
internetmatters.org
Advice, guides and tools for parents

REMEMBER

Your involvement today helps your child build confidence and make safer choices tomorrow.

NEED TO TALK? CHILDLINE 0800 1111

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childline.org.uk

YOU ARE NOT ALONE
We're here for you.